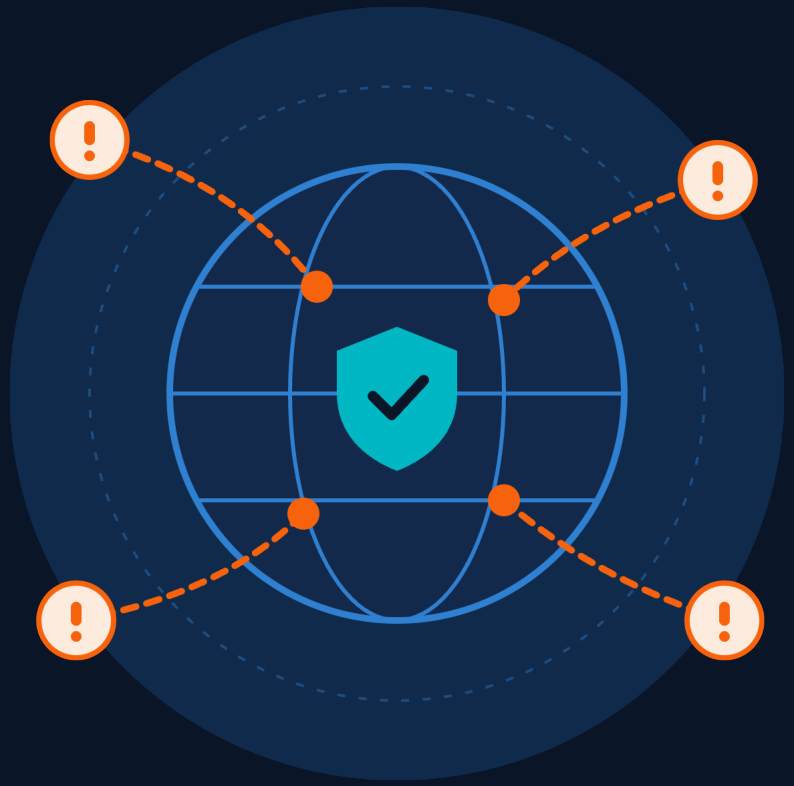
ZNEXORA TECH | SECURITY AWARENESS

Global Malware Attack Statistics 2026

What this year's threat data means for our unit



BASED ON

SentinelOne · Verizon DBIR · IBM · CrowdStrike

Presented by: **ZNexora Tech** · [Presenter] · [Date]

Malware never sleeps

560,000

new malware threats identified every day

500,000

malicious files detected or blocked daily

11 sec

between automated attacks

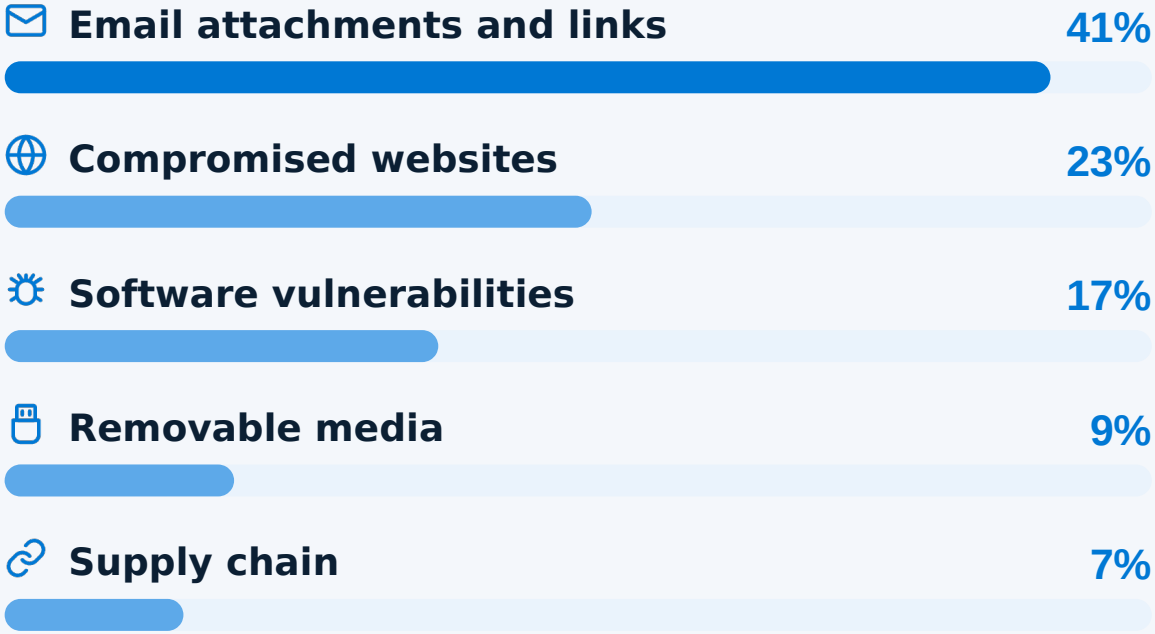
2,086

attacks per organisation each week, up 9.6%

In the 10 minutes of this briefing, automated attacks will strike **around 55 times**.

Source: SentinelOne, Malware Statistics 2026

Top malware delivery routes



+563% fake CAPTCHA lure incidents
SentinelOne

+131% malware-laden emails
Hornetsecurity

31% of breaches start by exploiting a vulnerability, now the top entry route
Verizon DBIR

Sources: SentinelOne 2026 · Hornetsecurity 2026 · Verizon DBIR 2026

Infostealers lead the pack

155,000+

infostealer detections in early 2026, the most active malware type

Most detected: Agent Tesla, Formbook and Lumma

72,000+

Remote Access Trojan detections, #2 worldwide

+220%

growth in targeted credential-stealer infections

+124%

rise in IoT malware attacks

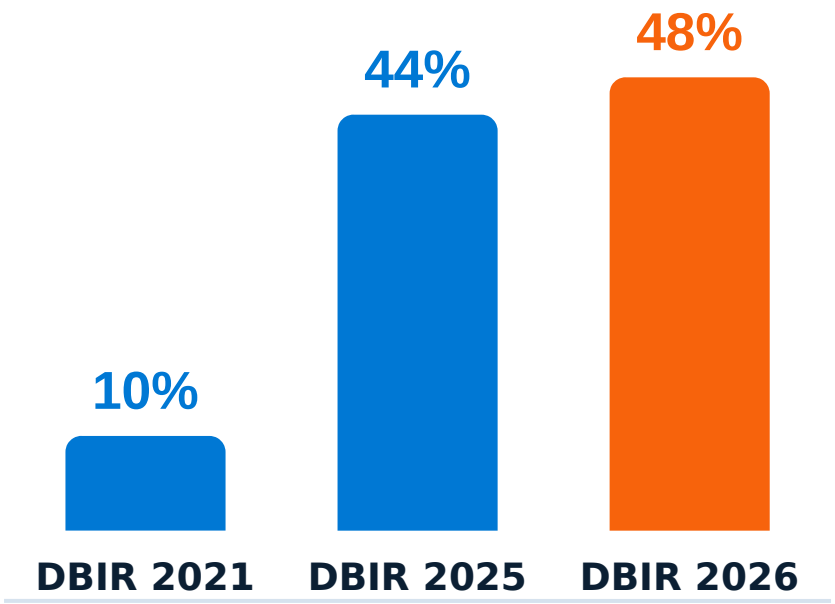
37%

of new malware uses AI-enhanced evasion

Source: SentinelOne, Malware Statistics 2026

Ransomware in nearly half of breaches

RANSOMWARE SHARE OF BREACHES



69%
of victims refused to pay, up from 64%

$139,875
median ransom payment, down from $150,000

Top 4
active families early 2026: Qilin, Akira, Clop, The Gentlemen

Sources: Verizon DBIR 2021–2026 · SentinelOne 2026

Attackers move in minutes

29 min

average eCrime breakout time

27 sec

fastest breakout observed

82%

of detections were malware-free

+89%

attacks by AI-enabled adversaries

Breakout time is how long an attacker needs to move from first access to other systems.

Malware-free attacks use stolen logins and trusted tools instead of malicious files.

Source: CrowdStrike 2026 Global Threat Report

No sector is immune

Manufacturing	**34.7%**	of malware incidents; ransomware drives 61% of its malware breaches
Healthcare	**$6.64M**	average breach cost, the highest of any sector for 13 years
Financial services	**$6.29M**	average breach cost, up from $5.56M
Government and public sector	**19%**	of global malware incidents
Small and mid-size businesses	**88%**	of SMB breaches involve ransomware, vs 39% at large firms

Sources: SentinelOne 2026 · Verizon DBIR 2026 · IBM Cost of a Data Breach 2026

What a breach costs in 2026

GLOBAL AVERAGE COST OF A BREACH

$4.99M

Up 12% in a year, the highest IBM has ever recorded

$11.5M

average breach cost in the US

247 days

to identify and contain a breach

$5.29M

average cost when phishing, vishing or smishing is the entry point

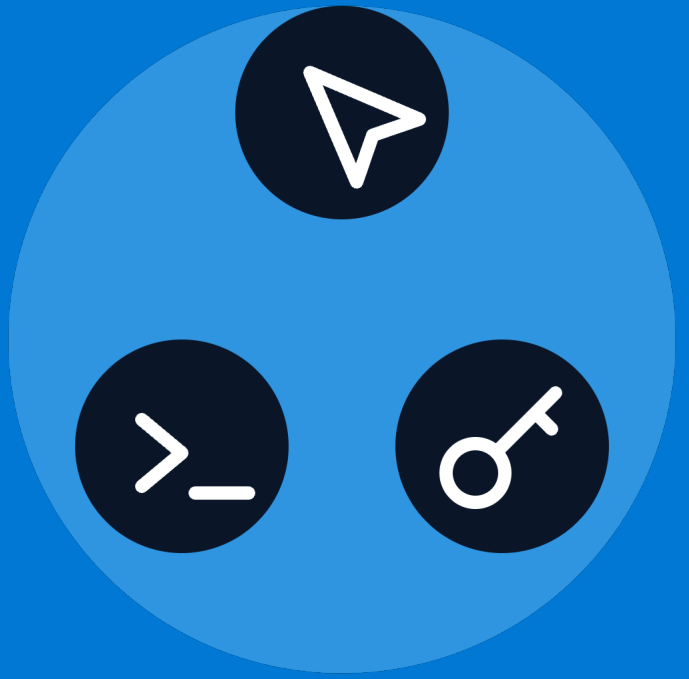
$1.93M

saved per breach with AI and automation in security

Source: IBM Cost of a Data Breach Report 2026

THE COMMON THREAD

Behind most statistics is one moment: a click, a paste or a reused password.



That moment is where each of us can stop an attack.

From statistics to action

THE STATISTIC	OUR ACTION
Email is the #1 malware route (41%)	Pause before opening unexpected links and attachments
Fake CAPTCHA lures up 563%	**Never paste or run commands a website gives you**
82% of detections are malware-free	**Protect your logins: MFA and unique passwords**
31% of breaches start with a vulnerability	**Install updates promptly and restart when asked**
Ransomware in 48% of breaches	Save work to backed-up storage, not just your desktop
29-minute average breakout	**Report anything suspicious to IT immediately**

Sources: SentinelOne · Verizon DBIR · CrowdStrike, all 2026

Sources

SentinelOne	Malware Statistics for 2026, updated 7 May 2026
Verizon	2026 Data Breach Investigations Report
IBM	Cost of a Data Breach Report 2026
CrowdStrike	2026 Global Threat Report
Hornetsecurity	Cybersecurity Report 2026

Figures are as published by each source. Some SentinelOne figures aggregate third-party research.

QUESTIONS AND DISCUSSION

Every statistic starts with one click.

Stay alert. Protect your logins. Report fast.

Thank you · Presented by ZNexora Tech

